

Robustness across conditions

Project: Reproducible AI Research Study

1. Prepare the purpose, prerequisites and materials

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Explain the mechanism and terminology of robustness across conditions

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

Retrieval answer guidance

Inspecting failures and anomalies

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Inspecting failures and anomalies. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of inspecting failures and anomalies

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Failure inspection generates explanations to test. An unusual result is not automatically a bad data point. Compare raw outputs, input validity and procedure traces. Correct demonstrable measurement errors with provenance; retain valid unusual observations. Label post-result investigations exploratory.

Reproducible environment and records

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Reproducible environment and records. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of reproducible environment and records

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: A reproducible environment record links code, data, configuration and runtime dependencies to results. A seed alone is insufficient. Record exact data IDs/splits, code version, dependency versions, parameters, randomness policy and raw outputs. Verify hashes for integrity without treating them as correctness proofs.

Predefining an analysis plan

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Predefining an analysis plan. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of predefining an analysis plan

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: An analysis plan records outcomes, units, exclusions, comparisons and uncertainty methods before primary results are inspected. Deviations remain visible. Declare primary metric, eligible cases, missing handling, baseline, test assumptions and reporting. Timestamp/version the plan; label later choices exploratory.

Two 45-minute sessions. Robustness checks examine a frozen procedure under declared varied conditions. Performance differences do not by themselves identify cause. Use the supplied constructed scenarios to make the mechanism inspectable. Collect W4 before sharing solutions. Students should name intermediate evidence and limitations; classroom pacing and learning effectiveness remain unvalidated.

Outcomes

Explain the mechanism and terminology of robustness across conditions

Apply the stated procedure to a new case with a traceable result

Identify an assumption or limitation and design a revealing follow-up

Preparation

Lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 for arithmetic; no live API or private data

Prepare the fresh retry separately and withhold its solution until after collection

Prerequisite answer

A result depends on the inputs, procedure and conditions that produced it. Preserve data roles and distinguish observed outcomes from predictions or unmeasured conditions. If the prior concept cannot be explained, use a short retrieval activity before this chapter.

End goal for the pictorial case

Explain robustness across conditions using the records and boundaries of this fictional investigation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

2. Explain and model the mechanism

Robustness checks examine a frozen procedure under declared varied conditions. Performance differences do not by themselves identify cause.

Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing. These are constructed classroom examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

Keep baseline, metric and eligibility aligned across conditions. Report condition counts and failures separately; new conditions may extend evidence but cannot guarantee all conditions.

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same inputs. If a required input is absent or violates the stated contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

Term · Meaning

Term: Robustness check

Meaning: Evaluation under declared varied conditions

Term: Condition-specific result

Meaning: A score within one stated setting

Term: Aggregate masking

Meaning: A summary hiding differing condition outcomes

Robustness across conditions — evidence trace

Input and scope · Check or calculation · Conclusion and limit

Input and scope: Method passes 9/10 on current sources and 5/10 on outdated sources.

Check or calculation: Keep baseline, metric and eligibility aligned across conditions. Report condition counts and failures separately; new conditions may extend evidence but cannot guarantee all conditions.

Conclusion and limit: 90% versus 50%; gap 40 percentage points. Freshness condition is associated with lower quality here; inspect mechanisms before general causal claims.

The figure connects this chapter's worked input, declared procedure and result. Read the complete worked reasoning for qualifiers and intermediate steps; the abbreviated labels do not replace that reasoning.

Guided: 90% versus 50%; gap 40 percentage points. Freshness condition is associated with lower quality here; inspect mechanisms before general causal claims. Qualification: Robustness is bounded by the tested variations and independent evidence policy. Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the mechanism; reject a claim resting on unmeasured evidence.

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Method passes 9/10 on current sources and 5/10 on outdated sources.

90% versus 50%; gap 40 percentage points. Freshness condition is associated with lower quality here; inspect mechanisms before general causal claims.

Compare the intermediate evidence with the final statement. Explain why each number or decision follows from the stated inputs. The conclusion belongs to this scenario and procedure; changing the inputs, evaluation population or authority can change what it establishes. Retain the raw record so a later revision can be compared honestly.

Thinking move · Teacher prompt

Thinking move: Plan

Teacher prompt: What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

Thinking move: Do

Teacher prompt: Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

Thinking move: Check

Teacher prompt: Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Robustness across conditions

Check robustness across conditions. A fixed classifier is tested separately on indoor and shaded outdoor cases.

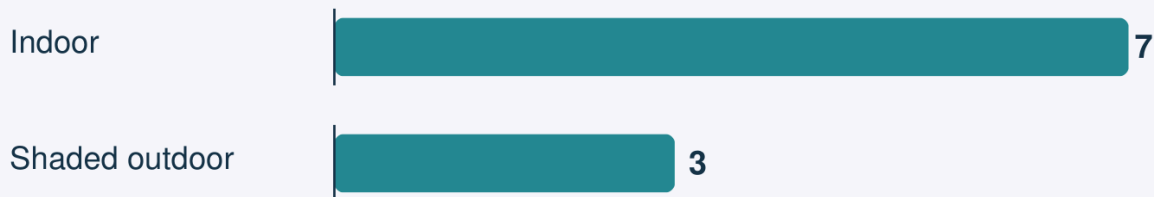
The facts we will use

Indoor 7/8 correct; outdoor 3/8 correct. The rubric and frozen model are unchanged.

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Fixed model across conditions

correct cases out of 8 per condition



Bar length shows the supplied value; the marked baseline is zero.

Robustness across conditions

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Name both slices

Each condition has eight labelled cases.



2. Compute rates

Indoor is 87.5%; outdoor is 37.5%.



3. Bound robustness

The large observed gap motivates investigation rather than claiming condition independence.

CHANGE ONE THING

Report only the combined $10/16=62.5\%$.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Name both slices

What happens and why: Each condition has eight labelled cases.

Step: 2. Compute rates

What happens and why: Indoor is 87.5%; outdoor is 37.5%.

Step: 3. Bound robustness

What happens and why: The large observed gap motivates investigation rather than claiming condition independence.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Robustness asks whether behaviour survives relevant changes in conditions. A total score can hide a weak slice; keep the scenario and denominator visible.

What this example does not establish

Eight cases per slice do not establish stable population rates or the reason for the difference.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Report only the combined $10/16=62.5\%$.

Prediction: The arithmetic is correct, but the condition gap becomes hidden.

Reason: Combining records discards the slice distinction relevant to the deployment goal.

Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

3. Demonstrate and guide practice

Time or stage · Teacher action

Time or stage: Session 1: 0–7 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the prerequisite; identify the input, procedure and evidence source.

Time or stage: 7–18 minutes

Teacher action: Explain section 1 and vocabulary. Complete W1 with a mechanism-based explanation.

Time or stage: 18–32 minutes

Teacher action: Trace the declared procedure and worked case. Complete W2, recording intermediate

steps.

Time or stage: 32–45 minutes

Teacher action: Discuss the diagram with the worked input; use W3 to distinguish measured claims and limitations.

Time or stage: Session 2: 0–8 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the worked reasoning and collect the guided response before discussing it.

Time or stage: 8–20 minutes

Teacher action: Compare a proposed boundary variant with the original case; identify what remains fixed.

Time or stage: 20–35 minutes

Teacher action: Collect W4 independently. Require the procedure trace and the bounded conclusion.

Time or stage: 35–45 minutes

Teacher action: Use W5 and exit responses for feedback. Administer the fresh retry after feedback and preserve both attempts.

Use the worked example in Sections 3 and 6. Collect a prediction before revealing its result; ask the learner to point to each intermediate fact.

Provide an input/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace. Extension: compare two concrete variants of this mechanism while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: Method passes 9/10 on current sources and 5/10 on outdated sources. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: 90% versus 50%; gap 40 percentage points. Freshness condition is associated with lower quality here; inspect mechanisms before general causal claims.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Robustness across conditions. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: Robustness is bounded by the tested variations and independent evidence policy.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Calculate indoor, outdoor and combined rates. Which relevant weakness disappears from view when only the combined rate is reported?

Reasoned teacher answer

Each condition has eight labelled cases. Indoor is 87.5%; outdoor is 37.5%. The large observed gap motivates investigation rather than claiming condition independence. Changed case: The arithmetic is correct, but the condition gap becomes hidden. Combining records discards the slice distinction relevant to the deployment goal.

Changed-case reasoning: The arithmetic is correct, but the condition gap becomes hidden. Combining records discards the slice distinction relevant to the deployment goal.

Collect each learner’s explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

4. Run the investigation and diagnose misconceptions

The worked result establishes every future case: Robustness is bounded by the tested variations and independent evidence policy.

A missing input may be replaced without recording the change: A replacement changes the evidence or contract. Record the change and its justification; do not silently turn unknown into a measured value.

Repeating an assessed case is new independent evidence: A replay checks consistency. An example used for feedback or revision cannot later be described as untouched final evaluation.

Use Section 9 for the evidence ledger. Add a boundary or missing-input case and record the expected response before checking. More successful repeats of one case do not establish wider coverage.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows · Next teaching action

What the response shows: Missing or misread facts

Next teaching action: Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows: Wrong procedure

Next teaching action: Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows: Arithmetic or implementation error

Next teaching action: Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

What the response shows: Correct result without a reason

Next teaching action: Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

What the response shows: An unsupported wider claim

Next teaching action: Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

5. Assess and explain the answers

Guided and exit questions

Guided: 90% versus 50%; gap 40 percentage points. Freshness condition is associated with lower quality here; inspect mechanisms before general causal claims. Qualification: Robustness is bounded by the tested variations and independent evidence policy. Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the mechanism; reject a claim resting on unmeasured evidence.

W1 Explain the mechanism

Explain the weekly mechanism in your own words. Use the worked scenario to name its input, decision rule and output.

Teacher explanation: Robustness checks examine a frozen procedure under declared varied conditions.

Performance differences do not by themselves identify cause. Keep baseline, metric and eligibility aligned across conditions. Report condition counts and failures separately; new conditions may extend evidence but cannot guarantee all conditions.

W2 Trace the worked case

Method passes 9/10 on current sources and 5/10 on outdated sources. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher explanation: 90% versus 50%; gap 40 percentage points. Freshness condition is associated with lower quality here; inspect mechanisms before general causal claims.

W3 Audit the limit

A report omits this qualification: Robustness is bounded by the tested variations and independent evidence policy. Explain how omitting it could change a reader's interpretation, and write an accurate replacement.

Teacher explanation: Robustness is bounded by the tested variations and independent evidence policy. State the observed result separately from the unverified or out-of-scope claim; preserve the original evidence rather than inventing a missing fact.

W4 Apply a new case independently

Baseline/candidate on condition A: 6/8, 7/8; condition B: 5/8, 4/8. Compare paired rates.

Teacher explanation: Candidate gains 12.5 points in A but loses 12.5 in B; overall 11/16 for both. Aggregate equality hides condition differences.

W5 Design a revealing follow-up

For the worked scenario, propose one additional case that could reveal a failure, describe its expected outcome before running it, and explain what would need to remain fixed for a fair comparison. Do not reuse W4 as a new final test after receiving feedback.

Teacher explanation: Accept a concrete variant of the worked input or a missing/conflicting/boundary condition, with an expectation derived from the declared procedure. Require preserved settings, original outputs and data roles. Robustness is bounded by the tested variations and independent evidence policy. The new case should test this particular mechanism rather than merely restate the original result.

Independent assessment and fresh retry

W4: Candidate gains 12.5 points in A but loses 12.5 in B; overall 11/16 for both. Aggregate equality hides condition differences. Require intermediate reasoning and the stated scope. Fresh retry: A baseline 4/6, candidate 5/6; B baseline 5/6, candidate 4/6. Expected reasoning: Gains/losses 16.667 points; overall 9/12 each. Preserve condition-specific findings. If students need support, record it and reassess with another new case rather than awarding independence to a copied answer.

Assess independent transfer

Selected case: Baseline/candidate on conditionA:6/8, 7/8; conditionB:5/8, 4/8. Compare paired rates.

Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: Candidate gains 12.5 points in A but loses 12.5 in B; overall 11/16 for both. Aggregate equality hides condition differences.

Dimension · Evidence required

Dimension: Explanation

Evidence required: Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

Dimension: Trace and result

Evidence required: Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

Dimension: Limits

Evidence required: States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

6. Connect the project, support and next lesson

Add a labelled robustness across conditions evidence sheet to Reproducible AI Research Study. Show how you can explain the mechanism and terminology of robustness across conditions. Use the supplied fictional case and keep its inputs, intermediate steps, calculation or prediction, and limitation. Connect this record to last week's record; a matching answer without a trace is insufficient.

Provide an input/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace. Extension: compare two concrete variants of this mechanism while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

Next connection: Negative results and claim revision. Preserve the current case record and retrieve its evidence boundary before moving on.

Retain the project ledger and assess a changed case after support. Check the relevant prerequisite before carrying this component forward.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-7/28, ai-7/30, ai-7/33. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record · Teacher evidence

Record: Learner code and date

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Concept and case used; prior exposure

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Explanation / trace / limits

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Support and first repair

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Changed case and delayed outcome

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Next teaching action

Teacher evidence: _____

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive

project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For the Reproducible AI Research Study, retain an annotated worked trace and the changed-case reasoning. Connect the claim to its records, units and assumptions so another investigator can challenge or reproduce it.